

Kathleen's rate. You are a very pleasant and polite person, and I bet they'll probably do the same for you!

Let's use some rough estimates to calculate the savings for Kathleen. There are interest and loan calculators on the internet that you can use. I am just trying to illustrate the point, so my figures are approximate. Kathleen's interest rate got knocked down from 22% to 9%. She had a balance of close to \$8000. Even making just the minimum payment would allow her to pay off the credit card in half the time and save over \$13,000 in interest! That really is astounding!

You can make your calls and work out your own figures. Then tell all your friends, so that they too can wield the same power.

Your telephone is a great weapon, so use it. Ready, aim, fire!

2. Call all your credit card companies and ask that they remove annual fees.

Many cards today do not charge annual fees because of the competition between credit card issuers. Once one company stopped assessing the annual fee, most followed suit in order to keep customers. Annual fees used to be standard though, and some credit cards that offer perks and rewards, like airline flyer miles, often charge an annual fee; sometimes it may not show up on your statement until after the first year or after an introductory period of six months. Review your statements each month.

Ed and Sue still had an old card that carried an annual fee, along with a couple rewards cards that charged annual fees too. There are simply too many credit card options out there today to pay an annual fee. Don't do it. If you see an annual fee show up on your statement, call and ask that it be removed. Most of the time, they should remove it. Two minutes of your time is certainly worth fifty bucks per card. "Hi, this is Ed Jones. I see on my statement that I was charged an annual fee, and I was hoping that you could waive that fee."

If at first you don't succeed, try, try again. Talk to a manager. Odds are in your favor that the fee will be removed. If not, stop